



Social warriors

Politically, many modern witches are advocates of feminism and defiant in the face of a male-dominated society. While feminism is not a prerequisite for the practice of witchcraft, the two movements share values. In the words of self-identified non-binary transgender witch Dakota Hendrix, “We are defying the patriarchy [and] the submissive norm.” Modern witchcraft promotes solidarity, actively creating a powerful support network for the more excluded factions of society,

such as individuals from the LGBTQ+ community and people of color. It now extends well beyond the Western world, with prominence in African countries as well as in Latin America, where modern witchcraft fits well with the strong tradition of *brujería* (folk magic and occult religious practices). Additionally, a “magical resistance” has been launched to combat those political forces deemed reactionary and repressive. In 2017, for example, American singer Lana Del Rey attempted “a spell to bind Donald Trump and all who abet him.”

▲ The activist witch

A group of modern witches, photographed here at the Free Speech Rally in Boston in August 2017, add their voices to those of thousands of protestors objecting to the alleged right-wing goals of the rally’s organizers.